DETECT THE DWELLERS · CHAPTER DICE TEST

A paper test of one idea: **match exact numbers instead of adding them up.** Play it, then play today's Quick Shift with the same group, and compare (see *docs/PLAYTEST.md*). Tuned for **2 players**; solo, 3 and 4 play the same rules.

YOU NEED

This sheet's cards. **Standard d6s in four colours:** crew dice (2 per player), 3 in a second colour for the solo crew die and agent dice, 2 amber dice for the row, and about **14 threat dice** to set under the mob cards. Coins for HP.

SETUP

1. Each player picks an analyst. Start at **25 HP**.
2. Shuffle the six mobs face down. The Lockjaw Syndicate goes underneath.
3. Shuffle the 8 agent cards: that's the kit deck. The crew starts with 2 agents (1 solo).

THREAT DICE

When a mob arrives, set threat dice **just below its card**, turned to the numbers printed along its bottom edge. Those dice are its hits. Each mob's numbers bunch round one main number, so a double on that number goes a long way. **4 players:** add the card's **+** die (a 6). Solo to 3 players use the printed dice.

Card ⚀ ⚁ ⚂ ⚃ + ⚅ per player past 3
1–3 players set ⚀ ⚁ ⚂ ⚃ · 4 players ⚀ ⚁ ⚂ ⚃ ⚅

A FLIP

1. Pick who's on point.
2. Flip the top mob and set its dice. If anything is on the row, roll the row: every row mob that comes back returns with all its dice. The two with the highest Damage hit everyone on the way in.
3. Fight. When the feed is empty, the boss arrives with one last row roll and no arrival hits.

THE ROW

Roll the **2 amber dice** and add them. A row mob comes back if the sum is **at most its number** ("back on 2–7" comes back on 7 or less).

A FIGHT ROUND

1. **Row.** From the second round on, roll the row first.
2. **Roll.** Everyone rolls one crew die. On point rolls two. Solo: two of your own dice plus the crew die (second colour). Each running Triage Agent rolls an agent die (second colour).
3. **Match.** A die takes out one threat die showing **exactly** its number: a ⚄ takes a ⚄. Turn the taken die aside.
4. **Hits back.** Every mob with dice left hits everyone who isn't blocking, for its Damage. A mob with no dice left is beaten.

DOUBLES

Your analyst card shows your doubles: Hunter 1, 2, 6 · Responder 3, 4, 6 · Engineer 2, 4, 6 · Soarcerer 1, 6 · Fixer 3, 6. Every other die (the solo crew die, agent dice): **only a 6**. A double **counts as two dice showing its number**: a Hunter's ⚂ takes two ⚂s, under one mob or two. **Or** it guards: you block this round. Never both. Agent dice can't guard or hit the boss.

AFTER A FIGHT

Beaten mobs go on the row, unless they already came back once: then they're gone for good. Draw 2 agent cards (1 solo) into the tray, which holds 5. Run an agent every round, or burn it once for its big effect. A die turned by Enrichment keeps what it was: a double stays a double.

WIN OR LOSE

Beat the boss and you've survived the night. Anyone at 0 HP and the shift is lost.

KEYWORDS IN THIS TEST

Beacon: roll the row when it arrives. **Piercing:** blocks don't stop it. **Targeted:** only on point takes its damage, doubled. **Evasive:** only a double can hit it. **Regen:** at the end of each round, put back one die it lost. **Escalating:** +1 Damage every round it stays up.

Prototype only. Numbers from the bot sim of 2026-10-30, exact numbers (prototypes/chapter-dice/README.md). Record: who played, time, win or loss, and every rule you played wrong.



IDENTITY — BACK ON 2–8

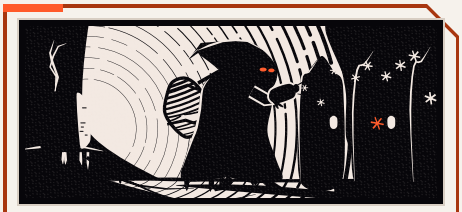
MAILER DAEMON

DAMAGE 1

BEACON. Roll the row when it arrives or comes back.

MAILER-DAEMON says your message bounced. Click here to retry. You never sent one.

+ PER PLAYER PAST 3



IDENTITY — BACK ON 2–8

PASSWORD SPRAYER

DAMAGE 1

PIERCING. Blocks don't stop it.

Summer2026! tries every account in the tower, one a minute. It only needs one to work.

+ PER PLAYER PAST 3



CLOUD — BACK ON 2–6

OAUTH CONSENT GRIFTER

DAMAGE 3

TARGETED. Only on point takes its damage, doubled.

A friendly pop-up asks if this app may read all your mail. Someone's thumb is already on Accept.

+ PER PLAYER PAST 3



ENDPOINT — BACK ON 2–7

LIVING-OFF-THE-LAND SCAVENGER

DAMAGE 3

EVASIVE. Only a double can hit it.

Rundll32, mshta, certutil: every tool it runs is yours. It lives off what already grows here.

+ PER PLAYER PAST 3



NETWORK — BACK ON 2–6

EXFIL COURIER

DAMAGE 4

ESCALATING. +1 Damage every round it stays up.

rclone.exe is moving 40 GB to a cloud bucket you've never seen. It's still small. For now.

+ PER PLAYER PAST 3



ENDPOINT — BACK ON 2–6

ROOTKIT IMPLANT

DAMAGE 4

REGEN. At the end of each round, put back one die it lost.

You count the svchost.exe processes twice. One looks exactly right, and it has teeth.

+ PER PLAYER PAST 3



BOSS — ARRIVES AT 05:59

THE LOCKJAW SYNDICATE

DAMAGE 9

DOUBLE EXTORTION. +2 Damage until it has lost two dice. Agent dice can't hit it.

+ PER PLAYER PAST 3

REFERENCE — EVERY DIE

DICE

takes out a under a mob

A die takes out one die under a mob showing **exactly** its number.

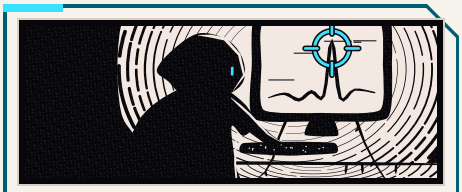
double takes — anywhere

A double counts as **two** dice showing its number, **or** guards. Never both.

Your analyst card shows your doubles. Other dice (crew die, agent dice): only a is a double.

4 players: add the card's + die.

Row: roll 2 amber dice; a row mob comes back if the sum is at most its number.



ANALYST — STANDARD D6

HUNTER

YOUR DOUBLES

A double counts as two dice showing its number, or guards.

Against a mob that came back from the row, your dice also match one higher or one lower. A comeback you finish is gone for good.



ANALYST STANDARD D6

RESPONDER

YOUR DOUBLES

A double counts as two dice showing its number, or guards.

Against the highest-Damage mob (boss included), your dice also match one higher or one lower.



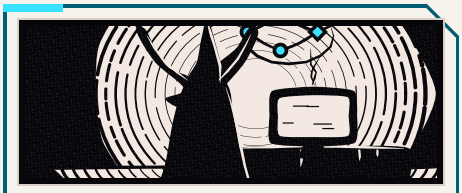
ANALYST STANDARD D6

ENGINEER

YOUR DOUBLES

A double counts as two dice showing its number, or guards.

Every even number is a double for you.



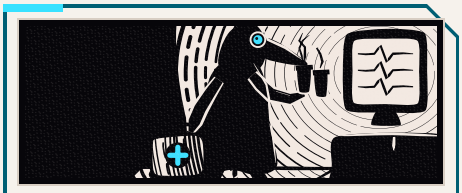
ANALYST STANDARD D6

SOARCERER

YOUR DOUBLES

A double counts as two dice showing its number, or guards.

The tray holds one more agent (6). Every won fight draws one more agent card.



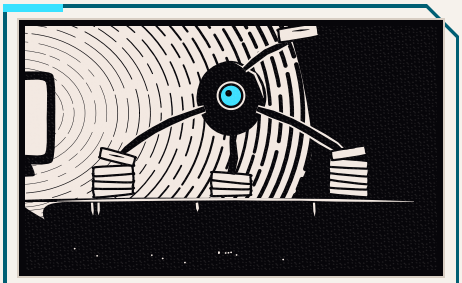
ANALYST STANDARD D6

FIXER

YOUR DOUBLES

A double counts as two dice showing its number, or guards.

After every fight, heal 5 HP split across the crew. Recovery Agents heal 3 more.

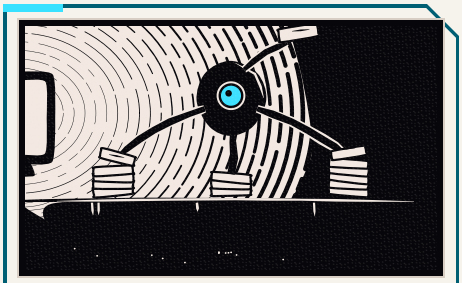


AGENT AI AGENT

TRIAGE AGENT

RUN IT
Rolls an agent die every round.

OR BURN IT
On point rolls 3 more crew dice this round.

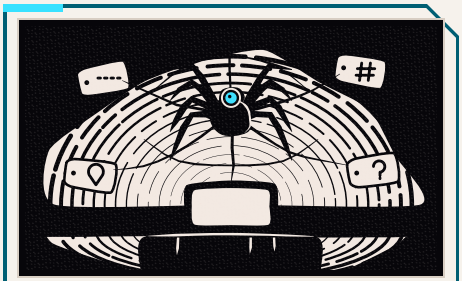


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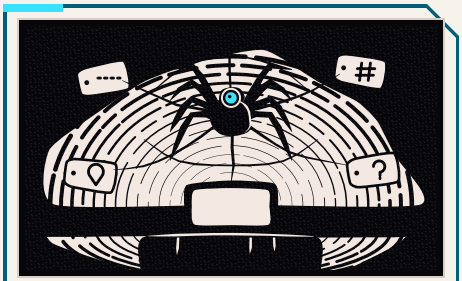


AGENT AI AGENT

ENRICHMENT AGENT

RUN IT
Once a round, turn one crew die to any number.

OR BURN IT
Every die matches anything this round.

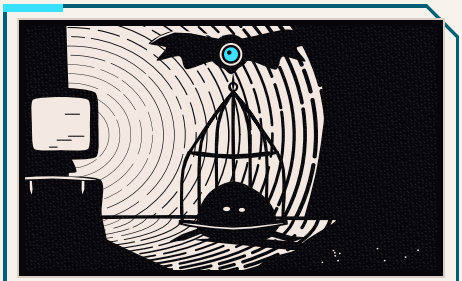


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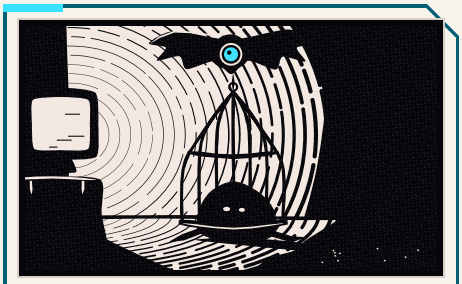


AGENT AI AGENT

CONTAINMENT AGENT

RUN IT
The highest-Damage mob deals 2 less, never below 1.

OR BURN IT
Remove one die from every mob (the boss keeps at least one).

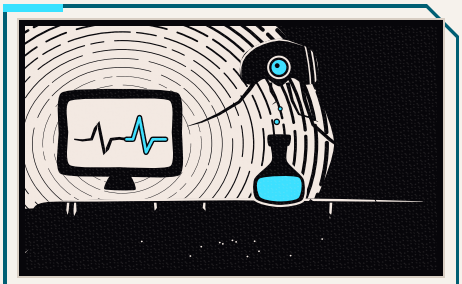


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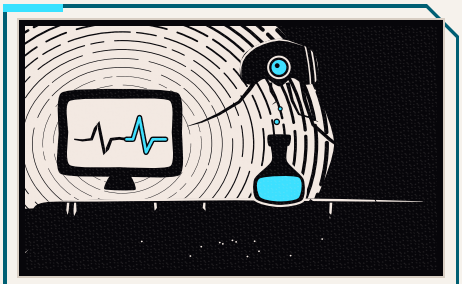


AGENT AI AGENT

RECOVERY AGENT

RUN IT
After every fight, heal 4 HP split across the crew.

OR BURN IT
Heal 6 HP split across the crew.



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